

ART TATUM RHYTHM CHANGES

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #171

Playing over Rhythm Changes, the chords to the Gershwin song I Got Rhythm, is the classic jazz testing ground. Learn your way through basic Rhythm Changes, maybe even have a couple different approaches to the tune, and you'll survive (and thrive) at any jam session, anywhere on earth. Here, we'll look at a gift to us from the great pianist, Art Tatum.

#1 - Rhythm Changes (first four measures +)

Cmaj7 Am7 Dm7 G7 Em7 Am7 Dm7 G7 C7

I vi ii V iii vi ii V I

In #2, below, we see that Art Tatum kept the "iii - vi - ii - V" progression in measures three and four. Of course, iii - vi - ii - V is the Circle of Fourths. He figured out where we need to begin in the Circle of Fourths in measure one, so that we arrive at the C7 in the fifth measure, right in time. That happens to be the b6 of the key we are in. Begin on Ab7 in the key of C.

#2 - "Art Tatum" Changes

Ab7 Db7 F#7 B7 E7 A7 D7 G7 C7

#3 - "7th to 3rd" Scale Lick

Ab7 Db7 F#7 B7 E7 A7 D7 G7 C7

#4 - Don Byas solo (live w/ Slam Stewart)

Ab7 Db7 F#7 B7 E7 A7 D7 G7